> *Tennyson saw with the poet's eye: 'When the war drum throbs no longer, and the battle flag is furled' 'In the Parliament of man, the Federation of the world,' 'When the common sense of most shall keep a fretful realm in awe,' 'And the kindly earth shall slumber lapped in universal law.' Yes, the kindly earth may slumber, but it will be no slumbrous time for the Great Powers for the two Anglo-Saxon races, combined with our friends in France, if they are to ensure that peace and that tranquillity which we all desire, and which we hope this League of Nations will establish* [emphasis added].

Despite these categorical professions of the League standing for Christian Peace and Christian Unity based on Christian Principles, some may point out that the Vatican was kept out of the League of Nations despite the papacy wanting to be a member of the League. Therefore, they could argue that the League was secular in character. But this would be historically incorrect for multiple reasons.

First, the Vatican was kept out of the League primarily because Italy resisted its entry fearing that the Vatican would seek return of the territories lost to Italy in the Italian wars of unification. Second, Pope Benedict XV's attempts at floating the Vatican's own peace platform after the war, although successful to a significant extent through its 'Concordat diplomacy', put him in direct competition with the US President Woodrow Wilson's attempts to lead the peace efforts. As revealed by a letter from Eugenio Pacelli (future Pope Pius XII), a prominent Vatican jurist of the time, to the Secretary of State to Pope Benedict XV, Pietro Gasparri, it was feared that Wilson's 'fourteen points' peace programme was the brainchild of the Freemasons who opposed Catholicism and 'supplied the United States with one of the cornerstones of its government, namely the democratic spirit'.[27] In fact, it was feared that Allied victory would 'Americanise the whole world, making it Freemason so as to liberate it from its servitude to the kaiser, the pope, and the priesthood'. The Vatican's opposition to the US programme ensured that the UK and France too allied with the US. The third reason for the Vatican's exclusion from the League is that some of the obligations cast on the members of the League were forbidden by Vatican's religious beliefs.

Therefore, the absence of the Vatican in the League of Nations is not proof of the latter's secular credentials. If anything, it only reinforced